HD Point, report, Model launch, Nigeria, 2026-10-30

Nigeria's N-ATLAS: an open-source language model for Yoruba, Hausa, Igbo and Nigerian English

What was reported

1. Nigeria's Minister of Communications, Innovation and Digital Economy, Dr Bosun Tijani, unveiled N-ATLAS, an open-source language model, on the sidelines of the 80th United Nations General Assembly in September 2025. **Verified** c1
2. N-ATLAS supports Yoruba, Hausa, Igbo and Nigerian-accented English. **Verified** c2
3. It was built by the National Centre for Artificial Intelligence and Robotics in collaboration with Awarri Technologies and other partners. **Verified** c3
4. The government first announced the project in April 2024. **Verified** c4
5. The language model, N-ATLaS-LLM, is fine-tuned from Llama-3 8B and designed to support African languages. **Verified** c5
6. It is reported to have been trained on more than 400 million tokens of multilingual instruction data. **Verified** c6
7. The release includes language-specific speech recognition models that can transcribe radio, television and online video into captions and subtitles. **Verified** c7
8. Documentation for the model is published on Hugging Face. **Verified** c8
9. TechCabal reports that its significance depends on whether researchers, developers and startups can turn the launch into practical tools for classrooms, clinics and farms, despite funding and infrastructure gaps. **Verified** c9
10. Awarri says developers, researchers and innovators can use N-ATLAS to build tools for education, governance and health. **Company says** c10
11. Awarri also says it is launching a locally trained, voice-first AI assistant that converses in Yoruba, Hausa, Igbo and Pidgin. **Company says** c11

How well sourced is this?

9 of 11 claims are supported by an independent source. 2 come from the company itself and have not been independently checked.

Source	Claims	Basis
https://techcabal.com/2025/09/25/nigerian-government-awarri-launch-n-atlas/	c1, c4, c9	Verified
https://iafrica.com/nigeria-launches-n-atlas-ai-model-to-support-local-languages-and-accents/	c2, c7, c8	Verified
https://techdigest.ng/launches-atlas-nigeria-first/	c3	Verified
https://www.nimdzi.com/language-technology-radar/ncair/	c5	Verified
https://www.tvcnews.tv/fg-unveils-ai-model-for-local-language-during-unga/	c6	Verified
https://www.awarri.com/ai-product	c10, c11	Company says

About this report

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